The river town woke slowly, and the baker opened his shutters before the first cart rolled over the bridge. Engineers measured the water level every morning and wrote the numbers in a book that nobody else read. The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away.

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By evening the market stalls were gone, and only the smell of bread and oranges remained in the square. When the rain finally arrived, it fell for three days without a pause, and the fields became small lakes.

Most visitors came for the market, but a few stayed for the quiet streets and the long view of the hills. The station master checked his watch twice, nodded at the driver, and the last train of the day pulled away. Children walked to school along the canal, counting boats and arguing about which one was the fastest.

The library kept its doors open until nine, which made it the warmest place in town during the winter. The river town woke slowly, and the baker opened his shutters before the first cart rolled over the bridge. When the rain finally arrived, it fell for three days without a pause, and the fields became small lakes.

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